

Brown Butter Financiers

Owner: Aiko Tanaka (Pastry Lead)

Summary: Almond-flour tea cakes; batter rests overnight; bake 400°F for 11 min.

Allergens: tree nuts (almond), egg, dairy, gluten. Store and bake on the purple allergen sheet trays.

Ingredients and Yields

- Use pasteurized egg whites.
- Sift dry ingredients to avoid lumps.
- Approximate yield: 1,120 g total batter ÷ 30 g per cavity ≈ 37 financiers.

Ingredient	Grams	Ounces
Butter (browned)	250	8.8
Almond flour	200	7.1
Powdered sugar	300	10.6
AP flour	90	3.2
Egg whites	280	9.9

Target deposit: 30 g batter per mold cavity.

Equipment and Station Setup

- Induction burner or low flame saucepan
- Medium saucepan (light-colored interior preferred for butter color)
- Fine-mesh strainer
- Heatproof container for butter
- Digital thermometer (°F)
- 2 medium mixing bowls, whisk, rubber spatula
- Sifter or fine-mesh sieve
- Piping bags with 1/2 in tip (or snip)
- Financier molds or mini rect/small oval molds (lightly buttered)
- Purple allergen sheet trays, purple-handled tools only for this item
- Cooling racks
- Label/pen, sanitizer bucket, disposable gloves

Preheat for bake: 400°F. Position rack center. Use an oven thermometer to verify.

Procedure (Do Not Deviate From Core Specs)

1. Brown the butter: Cook butter over medium heat, stirring, until milk solids are toasty and butter reaches hazelnut color and smells nutty. Immediately strain into a heatproof container to stop carryover.
2. Cool the butter to 110°F. Do not add below 90°F (too thick) or above 120°F (can cook whites).
3. Combine dry: In a bowl, whisk almond flour, powdered sugar, and AP flour until uniform.
4. Add egg whites: Whisk egg whites into the dry mixture until smooth and lump-free. Do not whip to foam.
5. Emulsify butter: Stream in the 110°F brown butter while whisking. Scrape bowl. Batter should be shiny and fluid.
6. Rest: Transfer to a covered container or piping bag. Label. Rest batter overnight at 41°F.
7. Prepare molds: Lightly butter molds. Set on purple allergen sheet trays.
8. Pipe: Pipe 30 g batter into each mold cavity. Tap tray to level.
9. Bake: Bake at 400°F for 11 min. Rotate once if needed for even color.
10. Cool: De-pan to racks immediately. Cool 15–20 min. Serve same day or hold per storage below.

Food Safety and Allergen Controls

- Cold holding: Keep batter at 41°F or below. Return to lowboy between batches.
- Cooling: If butter exceeds 135°F, cool quickly. Spread in a shallow pan; use an ice bath to bring to 110°F promptly, then proceed.
- Egg safety: Use pasteurized egg whites. Minimize time at room temp.
- Allergen separation:
 - Store and bake on the purple allergen sheet trays.
 - Use purple-designated spatulas, bowls, and piping bags for this batter only.
 - Do not process wheat-heavy flouring tasks or nut-free items on the same bench during makeup.

Quality Targets

- Color: Deep golden edges, light golden center; speckled from browned milk solids.
- Shape: Slight dome, no collapse, clean edges.
- Texture: Fine, moist crumb; delicate chew; not greasy.
- Taste: Toasty brown butter and almond; balanced sweetness.

Make-Ahead, Storage, and Service

- Batter rest: Overnight at 41°F develops flavor and hydrates flours; do not skip.

- Batter shelf life: Up to 48 hours at 41°F if covered; mix briefly before piping.
- Finished cakes:
 - Room temp, covered: Up to service day.
 - For next day: Cool completely, hold covered at room temp in a single layer with parchment between tiers.
 - Do not refrigerate finished cakes (dries crumb). Freeze only if necessary: sheet-freeze, then wrap air-tight; thaw unwrapped at room temp.

Troubleshooting and What To Do If

- Butter too dark/burnt: Discard. Re-brown; target hazelnut color and nutty aroma, not black.
- Butter added too hot (scrambled bits or greasy batter): Chill batter 10–15 min at 41°F, then whisk to re-emulsify. If curdled texture persists, strain and bake a test; if greasy after bake, remake.
- Batter too thick to pipe: Let sit at room temp 10 minutes; do not warm on heat. Whisk briefly to loosen.
- Over-domed with cracks: Oven too hot or underfilled. Verify 400°F with thermometer; pipe full 30 g.
- Flat/greasy: Underbaked or too much butter. Bake full 11 min; confirm deposit weight.
- Pale color after 11 min: Extend 1–2 min; rotate tray; ensure molds are lightly buttered.
- Sticking in molds: Increase mold buttering slightly; de-pan while warm; ensure molds are clean and dry.

Station Timing and Flow

- Day 1 (prep): Brown butter, mix batter, rest overnight at 41°F.
- Day 2 (service): Butter molds, preheat oven to 400°F, pipe 30 g each, bake 11 min, cool, tray for service.
- Batch cadence: One full oven per cycle; start next tray piping while first bakes.

Checks and Verification

- Scale checks: Calibrate scale before portioning. Spot-check 3 cavities per tray at 30 g.
- Oven checks: Use an oven thermometer; document hot spots; rotate at minute 6 if needed.
- Doneness check: Press center lightly; should spring back; edges set and golden.

Scaling Guide (Maintain Ratios)

- Maintain the exact gram ratios above. Example double batch = multiply each ingredient by 2. Portion remains 30 g; adjust number of molds and trays accordingly.
- Do not alter bake temp or time without Pastry Lead approval.